

Step 2: Can you control it in the manufacturer's app?

Apple's Home troubleshooting literally starts here: if it doesn't respond in the manufacturer's app, you may need a reset; if it does, your issue is likely hub/network/Home layer.

Step 3: What changed today?

New router? Wi-Fi SSID change? Power cut? Moved a hub behind the TV? Most "mystery" failures are "yesterday me" problems.

Flowchart 1: The "Device Offline" ladder

Use this in order. Don't skip rungs.

1) Power rung

Goal: confirm the device is actually powered and stable.

Step-by-step

1. Check the obvious: switchboard switch ON, plug seated, adapter warm/not dead.
2. For battery devices: remove and reinsert the battery (quick reboot). Apple recommends restarting accessories that aren't responding – often by reseating batteries.
3. If it's a hub (HomePod / Apple TV / Echo / Google hub / HA box): power-cycle it once.

If the home had a power cut: jump to the UPS/core-network section in Chapter 3 – router + hub reboot order matters.

2) Network rung (Wi-Fi first, always)

Goal: confirm your home network isn't the culprit.

Step-by-step

1. Reboot modem/ONT → router → mesh nodes (in that order). Apple's official steps include unplugging and plugging back modem/router when accessories aren't responding.
2. Confirm your phone is on the same Wi-Fi SSID you expect (Main vs IoT lane vs Guest).
3. If only IoT devices are flaking: check 2.4 GHz band stability and channel planning (Chapter 3).
4. If you recently changed Wi-Fi name/password: most IoT devices don't "figure it out" – they need reconfiguration.
Shortcut: if everything got worse at once, it's network/radio congestion, not ten devices "deciding to be dramatic."

3) Hub / controller rung

Goal: ensure the "brain" is online and reachable.

- **Apple Home:** restart home hubs and bridges (HomePod / Apple TV / third-party bridges). Apple explicitly recommends restarting bridges and home hubs.
- **Alexa:** Amazon's help for "Alexa doesn't understand or respond" starts with checking connection and device state (muted, adapter, internet).

- **Google Home:** common fixes include restarting the app, router, and the device/hub running the integration.

Step-by-step

1. Confirm the hub/controller device is powered and connected (app shows it online).
2. Reboot the hub/controller once.
3. If you use Home Assistant: confirm Home Assistant itself is reachable locally.

4) App / integration rung (the "software handshake")

Goal: identify whether it's a local device problem or a cloud-link problem.

Step-by-step

1. Test control in the manufacturer app (again). If it works there but not in your main app, the issue is your ecosystem link.
2. For Google Home cloud-linked devices: try unlinking/relinking the service as suggested in community guidance.
3. For Apple Home: check for firmware updates in the manufacturer app; Apple recommends this explicitly.

5) Reset rung (last resort)

Factory reset is useful – but it's also a blunt instrument.

Do reset when:

- device won't respond in its own app after power/network fixes
- you changed Wi-Fi credentials and the device cannot be updated
- it's stuck in a broken pairing state

Don't reset when:

- a whole batch of devices went offline (that's usually router/hub/radio)
- automations stopped but manual control works (that's logic, not pairing)

Flowchart 2: "Automation didn't trigger" ladder

Automations fail for three reasons:

1. trigger didn't happen (or wasn't seen)
2. condition blocked it
3. action failed

Step-by-step (universal)

1. Confirm the trigger event exists. Did the sensor actually change state?
2. Run actions manually. If actions work manually, trigger/conditions are the issue. (This is a common Home Assistant troubleshooting method in the community.)